

Testimony of Harold Floyd (Philadelphia Regional Hearing)

50 years ago, I entered into the service of my country, first at West Point and later for five years as a field artillery officer. I was willing to put my life on the line if called to do so because I believed in the United States and its ideals. For the last 40+ years I have been a PA citizen, and in the last ten I have become aware of PA as a heavily gerrymandered state. Gerrymandering is a perversion of our democratic ideals. I lived in the former PA 7th congressional district, drawn to protect the former congressman Pat Meehan and designed to minimize the votes of certain groups. The whole thing was embarrassing (remember Goofy kicking Donald?) and certainly undermined my faith in our Commonwealth and Nation. While the gerrymandered congressional districts were subsequently redrawn by the State Supreme Court, this time I want the districts drawn much more reasonably to reflect the local communities. I think the best rule to follow is the one from the PA constitution regarding state legislative districts, ie 'Unless absolutely necessary, no county, city, incorporated town, borough, township or ward shall be divided in forming either a senatorial or representative district.' In other words, I hope you will do the right thing this time, rather than what happened ten years ago. Thank you, we are counting on you.